

Skills Summary

How Many? Counting Objects One by One

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Counting a Row of Objects

Rule: Touch each object **one time** and say **one number** for it. The last number you say tells *how many* there are in all.

Example: Count the row: • • • • •

Step 1. Count one-to-one — touch each dot once so no dot is skipped or counted twice.

Step 2. “One, two, three, four, five, six.” The count ends at six, so there are **6** dots.

Try it: Count the row: • • • • • • • •

check: 8

(!) Watch out: Saying numbers faster than you touch breaks the one-number-per-object match — that is how dots get skipped or counted twice.

Skill 2 — Counting an Array

Rule: In an array, count **one row**, then **count on** through the next row. Every row of the same size adds the same number.

Example: An array has two rows with four dots in each row. How many dots?

Step 1. Count the first row, then keep the count going into the second row instead of starting over.

Step 2. First row: four. Count on: “five, six, seven, eight” — $4 + 4 = 8$.

Try it: An array has two rows with five dots in each row. How many dots?

check: 10

Skill 3 — Counting on a Ten-Frame

Rule: A ten-frame has two rows of five boxes. A **full top row is 5** — you do not need to recount it. Count on from five for the bottom row.

Example: A ten-frame has a full top row and two dots in the bottom row. How many dots?

Step 1. The full top row is five without recounting, so start the count at five and count on.

Step 2. “Six, seven” — $5 + 2 = 7$.

Try it: A ten-frame has a full top row and four dots in the bottom row. How many dots?

check: 9